teammates put everything on the line in the sort of pressurized situation we all live for as international sportsmen, but distance gave me a different perspective.

I had never seen Lord's so energized; it had the feel of Edgbaston on a particularly mad day. Chris, my father-in-law, was there with his son Henry. The couple in front of them walked out with four overs remaining because they could not bear to see England lose. The sense of disbelief spread to our dressing room, where someone announced: 'If Stokesy pulls this off it will be the best finish ever.'

As future schoolboys will hopefully be able to recount, England – well, Ben Stokes – needed 15 to win in the final regulation over. The truth of Andy Flower's phrase, about teams or individuals revealing themselves, was reinforced when Stokesy refused to take a single from the first two balls of the over. He was effectively taking responsibility for four years' work, and precise performance planning.

He looked spent, but was sending out the message, 'I will do this.' That took incredible nerve and confidence. Earlier in his career he would not have had the mental discipline, strength and courage to take it so deep. I usually hesitate about using such a word in a sporting context, but it was heroic. It made me so proud of him.

I do not wish to claim credit for any aspect of his career, but he came into our England side as a very rough diamond. He – no one else, despite those around him – has turned himself into the world-class cricketer we saw that day. He delivered when it mattered most, which, to reiterate another eternal truth, is the essence of mental strength.

We've subsequently seen many scenes of people cheering the freakish deflection off his bat as he dived to make his ground, which reduced England's target to three off the final two deliveries. The Essex team (Quinny apart, for obvious reasons) were no different. I jokingly exclaimed through the din, 'I never get overthrows like that.'

We had the luxury of losing our minds. Stokesy was thinking clearly. He changed his approach and even went against a fundamental aspect of his character, by refusing to take the risk of the 'hero' shot over the top. He preferred to concentrate on getting bat on ball, and ensuring that, at worst, England would have that super over.

He succeeded, despite Trent Boult's comparable brilliance, in having the calmness to complete run outs of Adil Rashid and Mark Wood from those